Discussion questions

The Sleepover Chocolate Disaster · for reading aloud at home, book clubs and classrooms

Pick two or three — not all of them. There are no wrong answers here, only unfinished ones. The best answers start with "because."

Before reading

1. Look at the cover: a cake, a mug, a moon and some stars. What time of day do you think this story happens? What are your clues?
2. The title says disaster. What do you predict will go wrong at this sleepover?
3. Chapter 1 is called "Best. Night. Ever." What would make a night the best night ever?

During reading — chapter stops

Chapter 1 · Best. Night. Ever. *page 1*

1. Jiwoo packs her notebook "for important science." What would you pack for a sleepover — and why?
2. The snack tray is "EXTREMELY thoughtful." Then nobody says anything for a long, important moment. What do you think the three friends are thinking?

Chapter 2 · Bananas and the Moon *page 7*

1. Maya calls it "the snack tray for a Tuesday afternoon." What makes a snack feel like a party snack?
2. Jiwoo says dark snacks at night are "a known fact of physics." Are they? How could you tell whether something really is a known fact?

Chapter 3 · Like a Thief in a Movie *page 11*

1. The pretzel bags are labeled SOCCER SATURDAY. What could a label like that be telling you?
2. Jiwoo thinks, "This is going so well." Then Maya opens the fridge. What do you predict is inside?

Chapter 4 · A Sign from the Universe *page 13*

1. Maya asks, "Who's the cake for, though?" Theo says, "Who cares?" Which one is thinking like a scientist?
2. Theo says, "Nobody will notice one slice." Then the book tells you that "somebody is definitely going to notice." Why would an author give away what happens next?

Chapter 5 · Subject Has Been Warned *page 16*

1. Lumi warns Jiwoo once, then writes, "Recording: subject has been warned." Why doesn't she try to stop her?
2. At midnight, Maya, Theo and Jiwoo each notice something different in their bodies. What does each one notice?

Chapter 6 · The Sleepiness Chair *page 22*

1. Explain the Sleepiness Chair to someone who hasn't read the book.
2. One of the factory workers' signs says "SOMEONE ELSE'S CAKE." Does Jiwoo know that yet? Why might the author put it there?

Chapter 7 · Thirty-Two Stars *page 26*

1. Maya was asleep at 1:45 and Theo at 2:00. Jiwoo counted the stars four times. Same cake, same hour — why might three bodies answer differently?
2. On Saturday, Jiwoo's legs "felt like they had borrowed someone else's body." What else did one late night change?

Chapter 8 · Two Lessons, Not One *page 33*

1. Jiwoo asks, "So I should never eat chocolate at night?" Lumi says, "That's not what I said." What did Lumi say?
2. What are Jiwoo's two lessons? Lumi says the second one "wasn't about bodies." Which lesson matters more to you — and why?

After reading — the big questions

1. Lumi says, "A question mark is honest data." Why would a scientist write down "I don't know"?
2. Four things were true at once (page 46). If you could change only ONE, which would you choose — and why only one?
3. Lumi blames the clock, not the cake: "Same cake. Wrong clock." What does she mean?
4. Jiwoo stayed awake longer than Maya and Theo. Lumi says, "Different isn't wrong." Do you agree?
5. Nobody in this story calls chocolate bad. Why do you think the author wrote it that way?
6. If Lumi sat on your bedside lamp tonight, what would she write on her clipboard?

In the car, at dinner — short versions for families

- What's one thing your body told you today?
- What helps you wind down before bed?
- Did you ask a good question today — like Maya's "Who's the cake for, though?"

There are no wrong answers here. There are unfinished ones. — L.